

VINITHA MAHADEVAN

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Lead Release Train Engineer with 20+ years of experience in Agile program management, SAFe implementation, and large-scale technology delivery. Proven track record of leading Agile Release Trains (ARTs), driving PI Planning, Continuous Planning and aligning cross-functional teams to deliver business value. Expertise in SAFe transformation, stakeholder engagement, dependency management, and risk mitigation across automotive, healthcare, insurance, banking, retail, manufacturing, and logistics sectors.

CORE COMPETENCIES

SAFe RTE | Continuous Planning | ART Execution | Agile Coaching | Lean-Agile Principles | Scrum | Kanban | Program Increment | Dependency Management | Risk Management | Stakeholder Management | Release Management | Continuous Improvement | Jira | Confluence | Rally | MS Project | DevOps | CI/CD | Scaled Agile Framework | Team Facilitation | Metrics & Reporting | CAPEX/OPEX Reporting | Cross-Functional Collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Release Train Engineer

Cox Automotive Inc., Sandy Springs, GA | April 2022 - Present

- Led the I&I ART with 12+ teams, coordinating 346+ Rally artifacts across strategic, KTLO, and compliance workstreams
- Drove Continuous Planning ceremonies, ART sync, System Demos, and Inspect & Adapt workshops each quarter
- Managed parallel strategic programs including AiM Integration, and AI Transformation (AIT)
- Shepherded cross-train dependencies across Auction Accelerators, Mashery/CIP SWAT, OnRamp/VCF, Vikings, Wholesale Auction DS, and Client Foundation teams
- Managed platform modernization: ActiveMQ upgrade (Java 21, Camel 4.x), Encrypt-at-REST, GitHub Actions, OS patching, and Mashery decommissioning
- Delivered KTLO and compliance programs (patching, encryption, WAF, version upgrades) alongside strategic transformation initiatives each quarter
- Presented RTE retrospectives and risk reports to AVP-level leadership, surfacing capacity, bandwidth, and estimation risks proactively
- Spearheaded the AI Transformation (AIT) program, establishing AI-first delivery practices using

a Software-Defined Delivery (SDD) model across the I&I ART

- - Stood up 2 onshore AI-focused teams, defining sprint cadences, team agreements, and delivery metrics for early-stage AI product development
- - Coordinated AIT dependencies with offshore expansion planning, balancing capacity constraints and sprint readiness signals before scaling
- - Managed AIT alongside 2 other concurrent strategic programs (AiM Integration and Disclosures to AWS), maintaining delivery velocity across all three
- - Partnered with product and engineering leadership to align AI roadmap priorities with investment objectives and ART-level capacity planning

Senior Release Train Engineer

MerchantE, Alpharetta, GA | September 2021 - March 2022

- Served as RTE for a fintech ART, facilitating PI Planning and aligning multiple Scrum teams to program objectives
- - Coached teams and Product Owners on SAFe practices, improving predictability and team-level velocity
- - Managed ART-level risks, dependencies, and impediments to ensure smooth program execution
- - Tracked program metrics and reported progress to executive stakeholders

Program Manager

Anthem, Inc., Greater Atlanta Area | January 2018 - August 2021

- Led Agile transformation and SAFe implementation across multiple programs in a large healthcare organization
- - Managed program roadmaps, release planning, and cross-team dependency coordination
- - Coached Scrum Masters, Product Owners, and development teams on Agile best practices and SAFe principles
- - Delivered program-level reporting including CAPEX/OPEX tracking, FIT reporting, and executive dashboards
- - Facilitated PI Planning events, ART ceremonies, and stakeholder reviews across distributed teams

Senior Manager / Program Manager / Project Manager

Cognizant Technology Solutions | October 2003 - December 2017

Clients: Anthem, Sallie Mae, Express Scripts, Wellpoint, BCBSM, NASCO

- Served as Senior Manager, Program Manager, and Project Manager across healthcare, insurance, banking, and retail sectors over a 14-year tenure
- - Delivered large-scale IT programs with a focus on quality, on-time delivery, and stakeholder alignment
- - Led onshore and offshore teams, managed vendor relationships, and drove program governance
- - Introduced and championed Agile methodologies across multiple client engagements

TRAININGS/CERTIFICATIONS

Cox Automotive AI 101, 301 Training Facilitation

GROW Training

SAFe 4 Release Train Engineer (RTE) - Scaled Agile, Inc. | October 2020

SAFe 4 Senior Agile Scrum Master (SASM) - Scaled Agile, Inc. | June 2020

SAFe 4 Product Owner / Product Manager (POPM) - Scaled Agile, Inc. | July 2020

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering - Electrical, Electronics and Communications Engineering

University of Madras, Chennai, India

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Agile Tools: Jira, Confluence, Rally (Agile Central), MS Project, Miro

Methodologies: SAFe, Scrum, Kanban, Lean, XP, Waterfall

Reporting: CAPEX/OPEX, FIT Reporting, Program Dashboards, Metrics & KPIs